TA brief · access, kit and safety

Two similar-size clean blunt rocks, dropper, stable tray, towel, three dot counters per sample and a two-row record. An adult may handle kit while the learner directs and records. One page and pack cover both BUILD periods.

Follow the school risk assessment and approved practical guidance. Use clean blunt samples in a stable tray. Wipe spills. No tasting, scraping or forced touch. Wash hands after. Distinguish edge runoff from water passing through.

The pair works with a shared model and individual evidence. One explains and one asks for the clue, then they swap. Hear both independent reasons before moving on. Re-model an unsure learner’s step and use a fresh parallel question while the other continues.

No cold calling or forced public reading. A learner may pass. Point, sign, speak, draw, type, write, direct an adult or use exact scribing. Read the task exactly when needed. Keep the science challenge and allow planning in any language. EAL is language, not SEN.

Use the least prompt needed, then fade it. Keep prompts separate from the pupil’s response.

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TA brief · prompt ladder and stage handover

1. Point to the relevant place / instruction.

2. Ask one short question: "What is it asking you to find?"

3. Rephrase the instruction in simpler language.

4. Provide a scaffold or limited choice.

5. Model the first step only, then return the task to the pupil.

Arrival: predictable start and private choice. Starter: hear first attempts before answers. I do: point to the model and let the learner track each step. We do: leave the missing step to the learner. Independent: protect an individual first try.

Review and Exit: the adult receives the learner’s own science, names it back and agrees a precise next move. Record the deepest prompt and what was independent. No physical prompting; pass and pause remain available.

Timing: Arrival 5 min, Starter 3 min, I do 5 min, We do 7 min, We do 2 5 min, Independent 8 min, Review 4 min, Exit 3 min. Total 40 minutes. Alternative route views share the same task time.

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